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On day after, jubilation and resolve

CONGRESS

Clark says leadership team will be ready

By Tal Kopan
GLOBE STAFF

FAIRLESS HILLS, Pa. — As Revere Representative Katherine Clark stepped up to address a room of roughly four dozen volunteers in one of Pennsylvania's purplest suburbs one week before Election Day, she opened with a question: "Are you ready to win?"

It's hard to believe Clark or any of the cheering supporters could fathom in that moment the magnitude of the victory that indeed came to pass on Tuesday.

Riding into January on a blue wave of historic proportions, Clark is widely expected to be the majority leader in a new Democratic majority so large that any talk of factional strife has been swept away along with dozens of Republican members of Congress. But after their celebrations, Democrats will face a stark reality: the hard part of their jobs is just beginning.

Polling this year, which turned out to be fairly accurate, made clear that although voters were supporting Democrats, they still had misgivings about the party and were placing only tentative trust in their leadership. Clark and her fellow Democratic leaders will have two years under Trump's

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CLOCKWISE FROM THE TOP: BRANDON BELL/GETTY IMAGES, ANDREW HARNIK/GETTY IMAGES, KEVIN DIETSCH/GETTY IMAGES

At top, Senator-elect James Talarico and Texas Governor-elect Gina Hinojosa toasted with a fountain beverage at a Whataburger restaurant in Austin, Texas, after winning their races. House minority whip Katherine Clark of Massachusetts embraced House minority leader Hakeem Jeffries on Wednesday in Washington, while President Trump showed off the continuing construction on the White House ballroom.

VERMONT

Distance from Trump helped GOP governor survive storm

By Paul Heintz
GLOBE STAFF

MONTPELIER — Vermont Republicans were hardly spared in the nationwide drubbing their party received Tuesday.

They lost enough seats in the state Legislature to hand Democrats veto-proof majorities in both chambers. And their lieutenant governor, John Rodgers, was swept out of office by a 25-point margin.

But one Vermont Republican managed to survive the carnage, as he always does: Governor Phil Scott.

Despite facing his toughest race since he was elected to the post in 2016, Scott managed to defeat Democrat Amanda Janoo by a vote of 52 to 45 percent, securing an unprecedented sixth two-year term. Following Texas Governor Greg Abbott's defeat, Scott is poised to become the longest-serving governor in the country.

So how did he do it, particularly in a state as blue as Vermont?

Over a quarter-century in public office, Scott has built a durable brand as an affable centrist focused on affordability and uninterested in fighting the culture

SCOTT, Page A7

QUESTION 7

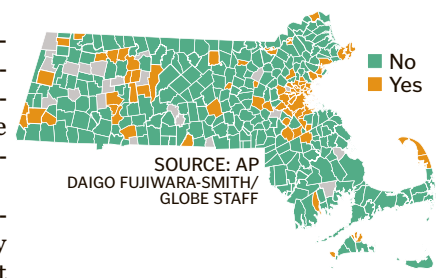
Deep split over housing reflected in close contest

By Andrew Brinker
GLOBE STAFF

Most residents agree the sky-high cost of housing, and the shortage of homes that drives it, is a seriously urgent problem facing the state. But that is where the agreement ends.

As of Wednesday evening, Massachusetts voters were nearly evenly split over a ballot measure that would reduce the amount of land required to build a single-family home here, with the "no" side leading by just under 29,000 votes (or just over 1 percent) with more than 94 percent of the vote reported, according to the Associated Press.

Question 7 was a bid by housing advocates to boost the construction of so-called starter homes and make homeownership more accessible to working- and middle-class families. The close vote highlights the deep divide over what to do about housing.



A shift in tone

Vice President JD Vance publicly broke from President Trump's defense of the Iran war. **A5.**

Staying legal

The state's recreational cannabis industry breathed a sigh of relief after a bid to dismantle it died. **D1.**

While Boston and its surrounding cities and suburbs generally supported the measure, many smaller and farther-out towns voted against

QUESTION 7, Page A7

MAINE

Despite the doubters, Jackson had what it took to oust Collins

By Sam Brodey and Emma Platoff
GLOBE STAFF

PORTLAND, Maine — One symbol for how unlikely Troy Jackson's victory over Susan Collins once seemed is the very room where he celebrated his triumph on Tuesday night.

Just months ago, the Holiday Inn ballroom in downtown Portland hosted a massive rally for Graham Platner, the candidate Democrats were initially convinced would be the one to finally oust Collins. When Platner dropped out in disgrace, many Democrats lost hope, convinced they could not beat the formidable Republican on a tight timeline, in the wreckage of scandal.

Jackson nevertheless took Platner's place with the daunting 100-day assignment to pry a Senate seat from the hands of the Republican who has most bedeviled Democrats, both in Maine and nationally, with her political resilience. Throughout his short campaign, Jackson was doubted, disrespected, and counted out.

But early Wednesday morning, in that same ballroom, he was exalted. Supporters chanted his name as he took the stage and joined him in singing the labor movement anthem, "Solidarity Forever."

The demise of Collins's 30-year Senate career was an unbelievable sight for many in this state she has long dominated — literally. The same polls that showed her trailing Jackson also showed his own supporters saying they believed Collins would win anyway.

That's exactly what the Republican did six years ago, instilling in her critics a fatalism that she could never be defeated no matter how hard they tried.

This time, Collins's time-hon-

MAINE, Page A6

Takin' a bask

Thursday: Warm again. High 71-76. Low 60-65.

Friday: Rain (remember that?). High 66-71. Low 55-60.

Weather and Comics, D5-6.

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Matthew Farwell's defense rested, bringing testimony to a close in the high-profile trial over charges he killed Sandra Birchmore. **B1.**

A former federal prosecutor will lead a criminal investigation into a former Cornell University student's allegations of sexual assault at a fraternity party. **A2.**

Global leaders offered little public sympathy to President Trump after his party's losses, even as they wondered what it will mean. **A3.**

At MIT, criticism, support around Sabatini

Some fear effect of $6m judgment; scientists question move to revoke his tenure

By Michaela Towfighi
GLOBE STAFF

The explosive court battle between a former star scientist at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology and a younger colleague continues to roil the Cambridge campus, with some contending the $6 million defamation judgment against the younger protege will dissuade others from bringing sexual harassment claims, while others are lobbying the school to reevaluate the scientist's position there.

These are among the first ramifications to emerge on campus since David Sabatini, a renowned biologist who was ousted from the prestigious Whitehead Institute at MIT over his relationship with Kristin Knouse, won a seven-figure judgment for defamation by a jury in Boston in October.

While no longer at the Whitehead Institute, Knouse still works at MIT as a biology professor, running a lab that studies organ regeneration; some students who work in her lab said they have received antagonistic emails from the public in response to the verdict.

One graduate student at Knouse's lab said it is painful to see her female mentor facing millions in court payments, and worried the verdict will have a chilling effect on reporting improper workplace relationships.

"I would 100 percent be scared to come forward and report something like this if I'm literally going to bankrupt myself," said the student, who asked to

SABATINI, Page A10